

COGNITIVE BEHAVIORAL THERAPY (CBT) – SESSION 3

New Case: Aryan – Worry Time & Continuing Cognitive Work
Full Detailed – More Realistic Style

SESSION INFORMATION

Client:	Aryan (32 y/o Male)	Therapist:	Dr. A.
Session #:	3 of 18–20	Focus:	Worry Time + Cognitive restructuring

PRE-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

Client brought the diary but again only completed entries on 5 out of 7 days. He attempted the behavioral experiment (setting a time limit) but found it very difficult and only partially succeeded. He expressed some frustration with himself. Today's plan: Review homework honestly, introduce ****Worry Time**** technique, continue cognitive restructuring on the key thought, and assign integrated homework.

SESSION START & HOMEWORK REVIEW

Therapist: Good morning, Aryan. How has your week been? Let's look at the homework first.

Client: It was average. I did the diary on 5 days. I tried the time limit thing for preparing code, but I couldn't stop when the timer went off. I felt too anxious and kept going. I feel like I failed at it.

Therapist: Thank you for being honest. First of all, trying is already progress — even if it didn't go perfectly. Let's look at what happened. What made it difficult to stop when the timer rang?

Client: I kept thinking that if I stop now, something will be wrong and they'll catch it in the review. I got more anxious instead of less.

Therapist: That makes sense. The thought "If I stop, something will be wrong" is very strong. We can work on that gradually. The fact that you noticed the urge to continue is already useful awareness.

INTRODUCING WORRY TIME

Therapist: One technique that often helps people with constant worry is called ****Worry Time****. The idea is to schedule a specific 15–20 minute period every day (not right before bed) where you allow yourself to worry. Outside that time, when a worry comes up, you briefly write it down and tell yourself "I'll deal with this during Worry Time" and then postpone it. Would you like to try this?

Client: I don't know... I've tried pushing worries away before and it doesn't really work. What if this also doesn't work?

Therapist: That's a fair concern. Many people feel doubtful in the beginning. The goal is not to eliminate worry completely, but to reduce how much it interferes with your day and sleep. We can try it for one week and see how it feels. If it doesn't help, we can adjust or try something else.

Client: Okay... I'll try. Maybe 8 to 8:20 PM?

CONTINUING COGNITIVE RESTRUCTURING

Therapist: Last session we worked on the thought "I have to be perfect or they will start doubting me." You came up with a balanced thought and your belief in the old thought dropped from 75% to 45% during the session. How much do you believe the old thought now?

Client: It's around 65% again. It went back up during the week.

Therapist: That's very normal. Belief often fluctuates. The fact that it went down during our session shows it can change. Let's look at the evidence you wrote for and against the thought.

Client: I wrote some points... but I still feel like the old thought is more true.

Therapist: That's okay. We don't have to force it to change quickly. We can keep collecting evidence through experiments and daily life. Over time, the balanced thought usually becomes stronger.

HOMEWORK ASSIGNMENT

Therapist: For this week:

1. Continue the daily diary (aim for at least 5–6 days)
2. Practice ****Worry Time**** every day for 15–20 minutes at a fixed time. Write down worries that come up during the day and postpone them to Worry Time.
3. Continue rating your belief in the old thought ("I have to be perfect...") every day and use the balanced thought when it appears.
4. Try the time-limit experiment again, but this time start with a very small task (e.g., 30–45 minutes of preparation) so it feels more manageable.

SESSION SUMMARY & FEEDBACK

Therapist: Today we reviewed your homework honestly, introduced the Worry Time technique, and continued working on your key thought. How are you feeling about today's session?

Client: I'm still not sure if all this will really help. But I'll try the Worry Time thing.

Therapist: That's fair. We'll keep going step by step. Any questions?

Client: No.

POST-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

- Client completed homework partially again (realistic).
- Behavioral experiment was difficult; client experienced increased anxiety when trying to stop — normal and useful for discussion.
- Worry Time technique introduced; client expressed doubt but agreed to try.
- Belief in old thought fluctuated back up (65%) — realistic and normal.
- Next session: Review Worry Time practice, continue cognitive work, introduce problem-solving if appropriate.

Disclaimer: This is a completely fictional but realistic simulation created solely for educational and AI training purposes. It does not represent any real person or therapy.